

From Desk Rejection to Acceptance: A Practical Playbook for Early-Career Academics

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Most first papers do not die in peer review. They die at the editor's desk. A desk rejection arrives in forty-eight hours, often with two sentences and no reviewer comments. For a master's student, a doctoral candidate, or a newly appointed assistant professor in India or another emerging research system, that email feels personal. It is not. It is a systems problem. Editors at Scopus- and Web of Science-indexed journals receive far more manuscripts than they can send out. They look for reasons to stop reading. This briefing teaches you how to remove those reasons before you click Submit.